



Security Watch

Trouble in the router

Problem:

Zlob, or DNSChanger is a Trojan that uses a simple but very powerful method to divert traffic from infected computers. This exploit bypasses the operating system altogether and changes the DNS settings on the routers, both wired as well as wireless so that all traffic goes through the servers of the attackers.

Zlob, one of the most common trojans to infect Windows machines is hidden as a video codec that has to be downloaded to watch video on certain sites. Once the malware infects the system it looks for a attached router and tries to guess the username and password from a list of matching combinations. Since most users hardly ever bother to change these factory settings more often then not the Trojan manages to sneakily gain control of the router and do its dirty work.

All unencrypted traffic that is either entering or leaving the user's network becomes vulnerable to snooping and malicious attacks. And the worst part of this is that the user would not even know of the security hole, because even an anti virus sweep on the infected system would not uncover the worm on the router. Also, in a network, traffic can be hijacked even if one computer is compromised.

Solution:

The solution to this exploit is simple: users should change the username and password of the router. It is advised you install latest system updates. And for users who suspect that their configurations have been changed, they should go back to the router's default configuration.

activities, than for being at the helm of the largest tech monopoly in recent years. And that's a legacy he would be more comfortable with.

APPLE NEEDS DOCTORS

Worm Hitting OSX

Apple users are known for their pride when it comes to anything related to the company. Even though any hardware that comes with the Apple logo costs an arm and a leg, people have all sorts of excuses on why it's better than others in the market. Security is one of the most touted reasons why people would go with Macs than be hobbled by Windows. The plot however, has changed.

One reason for the Mac's low susceptibility to malicious attacks is because the OS is based on the UNIX kernel, which is more stable than Windows' proprietary architecture. Also, the Macs with single digit market share did not prove to be a very attractive target for professional hackers, who usually aim at inflicting maximum damage. In the last two years, however, things have changed.

The visibility of Apple has increased in the personal computing space. The iPhone's stunning success has also contributed a lot to the visibility of Leopard, its operating system. Restricted till now to the personal segment, Macs are being used in the enterprise segment too. In the server segment, for long dominated by UNIX and Windows, Apple has released a slew of its own products. Some of them are used in mission critical role in organisations, which has

raised the stakes a lot higher in the cat-and-mouse game played by security researchers and cyber criminals.

The latest in the series of malicious threats targeting OSX is a Trojan horse named ASthtv05. Analysts from SecureMac, a security firm has classified the Trojan as critical and issued an all points alert for it. This Trojan can compromise the latest patched versions of Leopard and virtually take control of the infected computer. It gains administrator privileges after the user opens an infected file. It then opens ports in the firewalls, log keystrokes, transmits usernames and passwords, takes pictures with the iSight Web camera and turns on file sharing. It also hides in the background and might turn off system logging, so that the user has no way of knowing that the computer is infected.

Uncovered in a hacker's forum, the source code of this malware is freely available. This has led researchers to believe that several variants of the exploit code may ultimately be found in the wild. Currently Apple has not said anything about this threat, though SecureMac's security software can disable the Trojan. However, the researchers remained confident that Apple would release a patch for the exploit as soon as possible.

Till then, Apple users are advised to bite carefully.

HELP AT HAND

Browser For The Autistic

Autism is a condition that prevents a person from enjoying effective social



NVIDIA CUDA

What is CUDA?

CUDA or Compute Unified Device Architecture is a software development kit, to write C code for execution on the Graphics Processing Unit (GPU). It is developed by NVIDIA and is an alternative to Stream.

Why is CUDA important?

CUDA is built to take advantage of the processing power of graphics cards, to run resource hogging applications. Doing this, speeds up processing without putting too much strain on the CPU, keeps costs down, and making the whole system more energy efficient.

Where do CUDA-enabled systems come handy?

Apart from games, CUDA-enabled systems have wide scope in applications related to computational fluid dynamics, digital content creation, life sciences, imaging, video and audio, electronic design automation, oil and gas, finance and graphics among others.

Who can take advantage of CUDA?

Anyone with graphic cards from the G8X series onwards, can take benefit of the CUDA SDK. These include the GeForce, Quadro and Tesla lines.

How can developers access the SDK?

The CUDA SDK is available for free download from NVIDIA's Web site.

Which gaming components have been successfully implemented using CUDA?

The physics engine PhysX that is used by a number of games like *Mass Effect* and *Unreal Tournament III* has been ported for use in CUDA compatible cards. Besides, porting other games for CUDA, new titles are expected shortly.